

📱 + Holding Course the edges — offline · our outage · cold starts · the empty sky · a broken sign-in · phone + wall

The moments most apps get loud, designed so Vela doesn't. One rule carries the whole pass: the mark sits at the scope of the cause. One card breaks — that card wears its settled badge. The whole sky breaks — the sky speaks once, in one 13px line, and no card repeats it. Everything else is holding: last-known values kept and honestly aged, a clock that never stops, and healing that happens without applause.

One card breaks → its badge → The sky breaks → one line → Values hold, honestly aged → It heals → one breath of "back", then quiet

One fault, one voice

Signal scope maps to fault scope — a badge for a card, a line for the sky, never both for the same cause. The three faults read apart in a glance at 1b.

The clock is the floor

Local, ticking, never wrong. Every wall edge — boot, offline, even an empty sky — bottoms out at a clock, never a blank or an error (1e, 1f).

Truth at reading distance

The wall's mark is meta-sized in a corner — invisible across the room, plain when you walk up. Alarm radius: zero (1c).

Old beats blank

Cold launch opens on last-knowns from cache and freshens in place; skeletons only where nothing has ever lived. Offline keeps every number and labels its age (1e).

Scope: app-level edges only — single-card states (ghost · connecting · live · stale · error · empty) and reconnecting a broken service are settled in earlier passes and reused verbatim. Cards stay placeholders. Web render stands in for React Native; treat as experience direction.

1a The hardest seam — where does "offline / trouble" live? three directions on the same offline morning, then the call

TAKE A — THE SKY SPEAKS ONCE

Offline — holding your last picture. since 2:41

WEATHER · TODAY63°Clear · from 2:41

CLAUDE · SPEND\$12.40of \$50 · from 2:41

LINEAR · MY ISSUES62 in progress · from 2:41

One voice at the sky's edge — a dot, plain words, a time. Cards stay clean; the words carry whose problem it is. The pick.

TAKE B — EVERY CARD TELLS

WEATHER · T...63°Clear · from 2:41

CLAUDE · SP...\$12.40of \$50 · from 2:41

CALENDAR · ...Design review3:30 · Meet

LINEAR · MY ...62 in progress · from 2:41

Honest, but a chorus — six amber dots is loud by repetition, and it spends the badge's meaning. Rejected as the default; the badge stays the language for one card's own trouble.

TAKE C — ALMOST NOTHING

CLOCK · NOW2:53 PMFriday, July 10Offline · since 2:41

WEATHER · TODAY63°Clear · from 2:41

CLAUDE · SPEND\$12.40of \$50 · from 2:41

Calkest — one small mark folded into the card that never dies. But it buries the truth a level deep, and a sky without a clock card goes mute. Its floor survives everywhere below: the clock never stops.

The call — A, with C's instincts. On the phone the sky speaks once, in a 13px line above the cards. On the wall the same line drops to a whisper at reading distance (C's placement discipline). B survives quietly inside card detail text — "from 2:41" where a value has outlived its cadence — but the amber badge stays reserved for a card whose trouble is its own.

1b Three faults, side by side — yours, ours, theirs the same sky under each; whose problem it is reads in one glance, no error screens

YOUR NETWORK — OFFLINE

Offline — holding your last picture. since 2:41

CLOCK · NOW2:53 PMFriday, July 10

WEATHER · TODAY63°Clear · from 2:41

CLAUDE · SPEND\$12.40of \$50 · from 2:41

LINEAR · MY ISSUES62 in progress · from 2:41

Amber, because nothing is broken — everything is kept and old. No card badges: the cause is the sky's, so the sky says it once.

OUR SERVER — VELA UNREACHABLE

Can't reach Vela — our side, not yours. retrying

CLOCK · NOW2:53 PMFriday, July 10

WEATHER · TODAY63°Clear · from 2:41

CLAUDE · SPEND\$12.40of \$50 · from 2:41

LINEAR · MY ISSUES62 in progress · from 2:41

Red, because something is broken — and the words own it. Same anatomy as offline; no door to push. It retries itself and says so, so nobody debugs their router.

ONE SERVICE — LINEAR ERRORING

CLOCK · NOW2:53 PMFriday, July 10

WEATHER · TODAY63°Clear · feels 61°

CLAUDE · SPEND\$12.40of \$50 this month

LINEAR · MY ISSUESCan't reach Linear. Try again

No line — the sky is fine. The settled card-level error state carries it alone; every other card stays fresh and unbothered.

HOW IT READS, WITHOUT READING

1 A line means the whole sky. A badge means one card. They never appear for the same cause.

2 Amber means kept — old numbers, honestly labeled. Red means broken — and the words say whose side it broke on.

3 Nothing fills, nothing pulses, no screen changes color. The dashboard is never replaced by an error — the error is a guest on the dashboard.

Both sky-wide lines self-heal and never stack: if Vela's server dies while you're offline, you only hear about your network — the nearer fault wins.

1c Offline — the wall's finest hour nothing can refresh; everything holds; the heal is one breath

THE WALL · WIFI OUT FOR 12 MINUTES

Offline — holding its last picture · since 2:41

CLOCK · NOW2:53 PMFriday, July 10

WEATHER · TODAY63°Clear · from 2:41

CLAUDE · SPEND\$12.40of \$50 · from 2:41

GOOGLE CALENDAR · NEXT UPDesign review3:30 · Meet

LINEAR · MY ISSUES62 in progress · from 2:41

Across the room, nothing happened: the clock ticks, the picture holds. The whisper lives at reading distance — 13px, one corner, one amber dot. The calendar still knows the schedule it already had; time-fed cards age in their detail line. Never a banner, never red across a wall. After dark the whisper dims with the night clock.

PHONE · GLANCE, CHROME SUNK

Offline — holding your last picture. since 2:41

CLOCK · NOW2:53 PMFriday, July 10

WEATHER · TODAY63°Clear · from 2:41

CLAUDE · SPEND\$12.40of \$50 · from 2:41

The line takes the top slot where the header wakes — first thing read, then forgotten. Ages ripen in place: "from 2:41" today, "from yesterday" tomorrow. Values never blank.

THE HEAL — WIFI RETURNS

Back — catching up.

WEATHER · TODAY63°Clear · from 2:41

WEATHER · TODAY64°Clear · feels 62°

The moment the network returns, the line turns accent for one breath — "Back — catching up." — while cards freshen with their usual refresh mark. Six seconds later it sinks. No "you're back online!", no toast, no applause. Same heal on the wall.

1d Vela's server unreachable — our trouble, said plainly you have network; we don't answer. Same anatomy as offline — the words and the dot change

PHONE · 40 MINUTES INTO OUR OUTAGE

Can't reach Vela — our side, not yours. retrying

CLOCK · NOW3:21 PMFriday, July 10

WEATHER · TODAY63°Clear · from 2:41

CLAUDE · SPEND\$12.40of \$50 · from 2:41

GOOGLE CALENDAR · NEXT UPDesign review3:30 · Meet

Honest attribution is the whole design: "our side, not yours" closes the case before a person opens Settings, toggles wifi, or blames their router. No status-page link, no incident ID — it retries itself and heals like 1c.

THE WALL · THE SAME CORNER, THE WORDS CHANGE

Can't reach Vela — our side, not yours · retrying

CLOCK · NOW3:21 PMFriday, July 10

Detail crop, bottom-left of the stage. Everything above the whisper is identical to 1c — clock ticking, picture held. A wall never asks its owner to fix Vela's servers; it just keeps the watch. The two sky-lines never stack — the nearer fault wins.

WHY THIS IS NOT THE OFFLINE LINE, RECOLORED

Offline is a condition — nothing failed, so it wears amber, the color of kept-and-old. A dead backend is a fault, and it's ours — it wears the error red the settled card language already uses, scaled to one 7px dot. Same class of trouble as "Can't reach Linear," just wider — so it speaks from the sky, not a card.

1e Cold launch — the sky opens as you left it cache first, then freshness; skeletons only where nothing has ever lived

0 MS · FIRST PAINT, RETURNING PERSON

CLOCK · NOW6:42 AMSaturday, July 11

WEATHER · TODAY61°from 41 min ago

CLAUDE · SPEND\$12.10of \$50 · from 41 min ago

LINEAR · MY ISSUES62 in progress · 1 blocked

No splash, no skeleton wall, no spinner. The arrangement and last-knowns live on the device, so the first frame is your sky — honestly aged, every card already freshening (the one moving element each).

-2 S · FRESH, WITHOUT CEREMONY

CLOCK · NOW6:42 AMSaturday, July 11

WEATHER · TODAY63°Clear · feels 61°

CLAUDE · SPEND\$12.40of \$50 this month

LINEAR · MY ISSUES62 in progress · 1 blocked

New numbers replace old in place; ages fall away; pulses stop. Nothing announces "loaded" — the sky just becomes current, card by card, oldest first.

NEW PHONE · NOTHING CACHED YET

CLOCK · NOW6:42 AMSaturday, July 11

WEATHER · TODAY63°Clear · feels 61°

CLAUDE · SPEND\$12.40of \$50 this month

LINEAR · MY ISSUES62 in progress · 1 blocked

Signed in on a fresh device: the arrangement arrives with the account, so captions land first — the sky's shape at 0 ms — and values shimmer in. The Clock needs no one; it is it before anything loads. Shimmer sweeps, never splns.

THE WALL · POWER RETURNS, -1 S IN

CLOCK · NOW6:42 AMSaturday, July 11

WEATHER · TODAY63°Clear · feels 61°

CLAUDE · SPEND\$12.40of \$50 this month

GOOGLE CALENDAR · NEXT UPDesign review3:30 · Meet

LINEAR · MY ISSUES62 in progress · 1 blocked

Boot order: the field · the clock (~0.3 s, local, no network) · the arrangement from cache · values, oldest first. No logo splash, no "connecting...", and never a sign-in prompt on a mounted screen — if the session ever truly dies, the wall keeps clock + last picture and the phone gets the ask. Loading is not trouble: no line, no dot.

1f The empty sky — an invitation, not a void every card removed by hand; new skies are usually dealt a Clock, so this is almost always deliberate

PHONE · GLANCE

A clear sky. Nothing lives here yet. Everything you've connected is ready to place. Tend this sky

Centered, unhurried, no action. The mark sits dim — a socket, not a logo moment. No "oops", no illustration, no list of suggestions shouting from the void; Tend opens the settled add-a-card catalog. Other skies remain a swipe away.

THE WALL · POINTED AT AN EMPTY SKY

CLOCK · NOW6:42 AMSaturday, July 11

This sky is empty — tend it from your phone.

The wall's floor holds: an empty sky on a mounted screen is still a working clock — never darkness, never a setup screen across a room. The one whisper points at the phone, where tending is comfortable. After dark it embers like any night clock.

1g A sign-in fails mid-sail — no harm done during first-run, Linear's OAuth errors (or the person cancels) — the sail keeps its pace and everything lit stays lit

THE RETURN — CAME BACK UNSIGNED

Skip the rest

THE SAIL · NO HARM DONELinear didn't finish. It closed before saying yes — maybe on purpose, maybe not. Nothing was lost either way.

LINEAR · MY ISSUESYour issues, and the cycle's progress. CAME BACK UNSIGNED

Try again Pass

YOUR SKY2 lit

CLOCK · NOW9:41 AMFriday, July 10

WEATHER · TODAY63°Clear · feels 61°

Cancel and error land on the same words — "didn't finish," never "failed," and no red anywhere in first-run. What's already lit stays visibly lit below; the sail offers its usual two doors: try again, or pass.

PASS — THE SAIL MOVES ON

Skip the rest

THE SAIL · ONWARDWhat's next, and the day ahead.

GOOGLE CALENDAR · NEXT UPYour next event, and the day ahead.

Sign in with Google Pass

YOUR SKY2 lit · 1 waiting

CLOCK · NOW9:42 AMFriday, July 10

WEATHER · TODAY63°Clear · feels 61°

LINEAR · IS...Waiting — sign in anytime

Pass keeps the pace — the next card is dealt immediately. Linear waits in the sky as a socket, unit and unashamed, its count honest: "2 lit · 1 waiting."

THE REVEAL — SAME ENDING AS THE GOLDEN PATH

Your sky, lit. Linear kept its place — light it anytime.

CLOCK · NOW9:44 AMFriday, July 10

WEATHER · TODAY63°Clear · feels 61°

GOOGLE CALENDAR · ...Standup10:00 · Meet

LINEAR · MY ISSUESYour issues, and the cycle's progress. Sign in with Linear

The sail ends on the same reveal as the golden path — a socket is not a scar. The ghost carries its usual cost button, so lighting it later is the same gesture it always was. If they signed into nothing at all, first launch already handles it: the dim sky of the connect pass.

Try next: "prototype the offline → heal moment (1c) as a timed sequence" · "show 1b as one interactive phone that cycles the three faults" · "the night versions of the wall edges" · "go on to the card-faces pass (each widget's own empty)." Tweaks: annotations and the live clock can be toggled on this file.